the heart of or in the periphery of China's geostrategy shapes its take on India.

Finally, China's policy on India is influenced by the priority Beijing gives to wealth versus power. Although wealth and power are interlinked,[12] the priority given to each dimension can change depending upon the larger context in international politics. For instance, after a longtime neglect of wealth during the reign of Mao Zedong, Deng Xiaoping realised that China had to build wealth to gain power, and Beijing's grand strategy shifted accordingly.

These four variables have shaped China's approach on India and what kind of balancing efforts China has pursued towards India. Even though China's main balancing efforts have been directed towards countries other than India (because China has always had larger powers to take into consideration), China's increased capabilities have of course contributed to send signals of might and deterrence towards India. Still, in order to fully grasp how Beijing has balanced the goals to hem in Indian power to prevent it from dominating South Asia and to ensure that it does not drift into too close an alignment with other great powers, it is necessary to look beyond the traditional hard balancing measures. This echoes T.V. Paul's argument that although traditional balancing through alliance formation and military build-ups is the most significant form of balance-of-power behaviour, there is a need to broaden the concept of power behaviour.[13]

Nexon has suggested that balancing should be understood as a wide range of practices designed to rectify a security deficit.[14] Moreover, he claims that states balance with behaviour that "seeks to reduce their vulnerability to political subjugation – or loss of control over territory or vital interests – by either enhancing their own capabilities, pooling their capabilities, or reducing the capabilities of a threatening actor.[15] Similarly, Kai He argues that we should differentiate between positive and negative balancing, with the former